



medical centre in a hospital in Bangalore as a pilot project. Here along with alternative healing traditions, modern medicine is being used for investigations and diagnostic purposes. "I want to develop this model into a bigger multi-location business all across India," he says. With the Karnataka Government granting Rs 20 crore to the proposal, the Soukya-Sahaya model may very well be a sign of things to come.

The latest from real estate developers are "wellness homes". The Omaxe group, for instance, is developing ultra-luxury residential properties, across NCR and Punjab fitted with rejuvenation amenities—the best way to unwind from the corporate pressure cooker. "Our apartments will be centrally air-conditioned," says Siddharth Shekhar, general manager, corporate communications. "From sauna-steam-jacuzzi in the master bathroom, to spas and club facilities, indoor games and multipurpose courts, health clubs and even shopping malls within the complex." That's not all. Hotels are leveraging their wellness offering to establish new revenue streams, joint ventures are being floated to set up fitness centres in malls, private equity firms are showing interest in the wellness space and insurance companies have started innovating wellness packages (Max Bupa's Heartbeat Health insurance—covering a whole family, from newborns to senior citizens—has been launched this year).

A fun workplace sounds a bit of an oxymoron. But for Rajesh Kalra, 47, managing director of RMSI, it's an everyday reality. Despite a punishing work schedule, constant tours around the world, endless jet-lags and late nights, the former IITian keeps himself fit—swimming, running, gymming—so that he can continue to work hands-on with his teams as well as take part proactively in all their outdoor activities. When he started his career years ago in the infrastructure and development sector, wellness initiatives were just fancy frills that had nothing to do with the core development needs of an organisation. Even in 1994, when he started his



## 60%

of executives visit spas to relax, detox, beautify and pamper themselves.

## 76%

women go in for spa treatments, as do **24%** men—a rising category.

journey with RMSI, it hardly mattered to organisations if employees managed a work-life balance or not. "Today, India Inc has really grown in terms of corporate wellness," he says. And his personal ambition to create a stress-free workplace at RMSI has also paid off. "When our employees rate RMSI as the 'Dream company to work for', I feel that we are moving in the right direction," he adds with a smile.

Meantime—far from maddening cities, traffic jams and work cubicles—the biggest wellness deal is getting ready to debut. Here heaven meets earth. Clouds touch the Sahyadri range. Brick buildings jut out over the cool blue waters of the Warasgaon lake. Vivid earth shades—tan, rusty red, white—

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